Ex No:2 Setting up a Zoho Creator account and exploring the platform architecture and interface.

Shrivarthini - 241401100

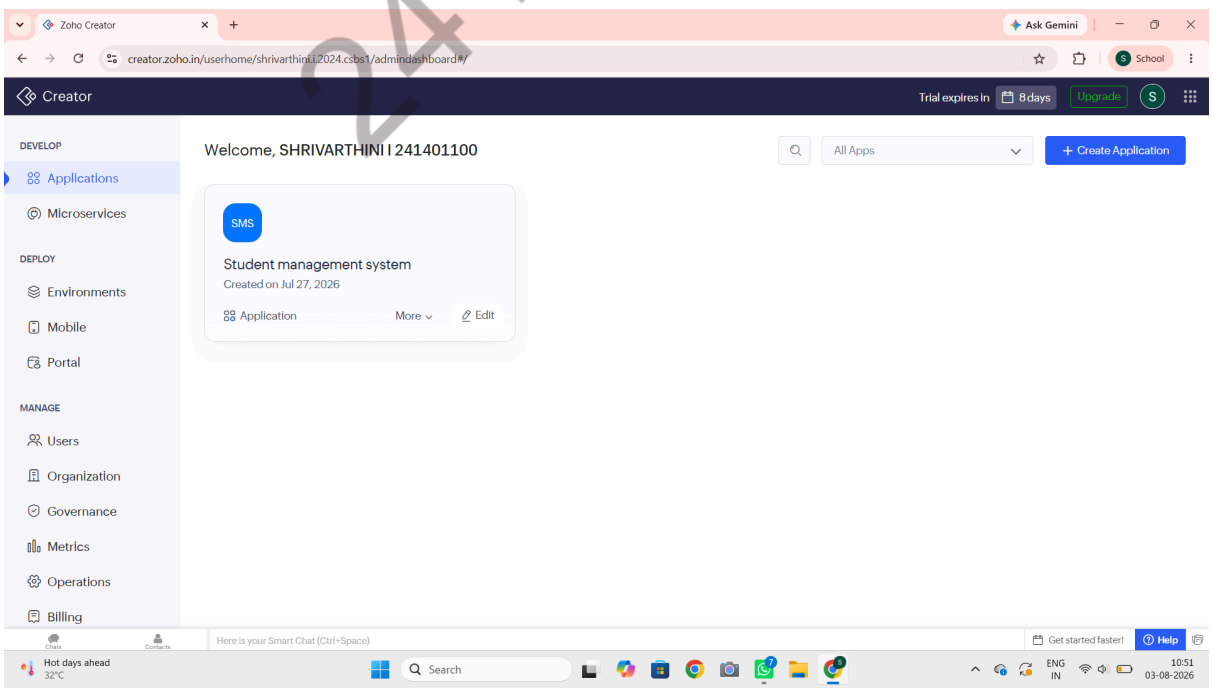
ZOHO CREATOR FEATURES DEMONSTRATION:

Application:

The **Applications** section within Zoho Creator is the core workspace where you develop, edit, and configure custom business applications. Key features include:

- **App Creation & Dashboard:** Create new low-code applications from scratch, templates, or spreadsheets, and manage existing apps (such as the *Student management system*) from a central view.
- **Component Development:** Build and edit essential app building blocks, including form interfaces, workflow logic, custom reports, and dashboards.
- **Access Control & Publishing:** Manage permissions, user roles, and access controls for individual apps before publishing them to end users.
- **Quick Management Actions:** Easily access high-level options for each application, including quick editing, environment settings, sharing, and app duplication or deletion via the **More** menu.

241401100

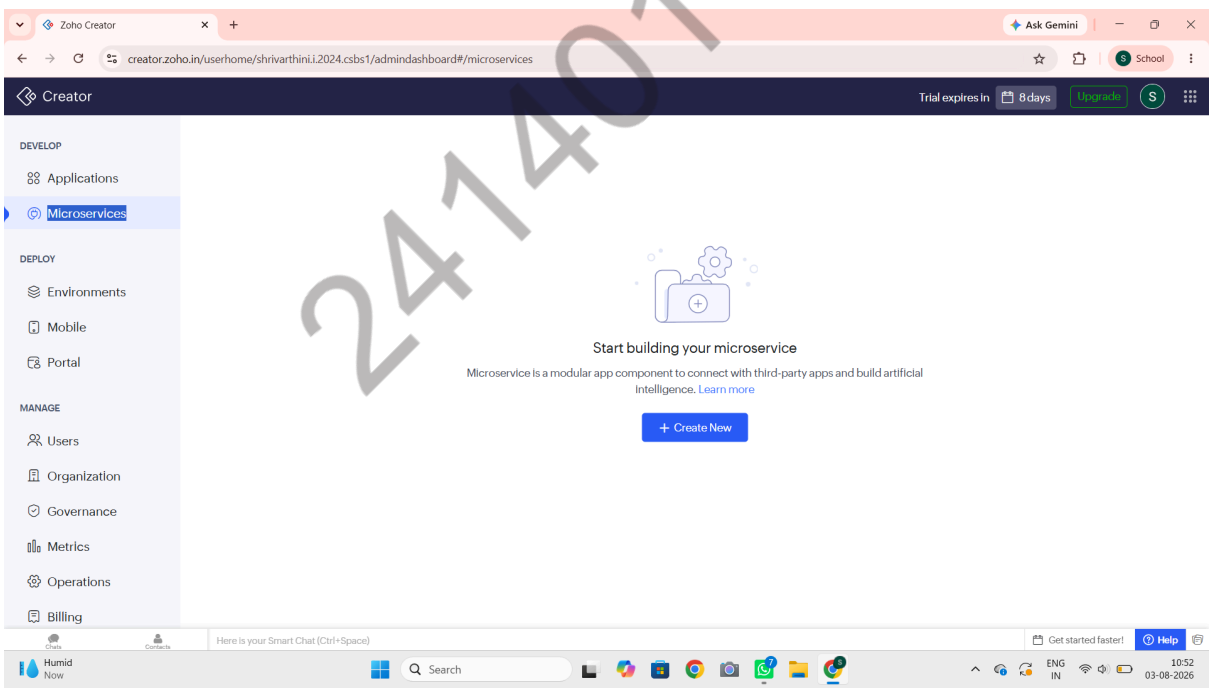


Microservices :

The **Microservices** section in Zoho Creator allows developers to build, run, and host custom backend code functions and modular APIs independently from individual low-code applications. Key features include:

- **Modular Backend Logic:** Write and run standalone code blocks (such as Java, Node.js, or Python functions) to handle complex backend processing that goes beyond standard low-code drag-and-drop workflows.
- **Reusable APIs:** Expose custom logic as HTTP endpoints/APIs that can be called and reused across multiple Zoho Creator applications or external third-party services.
- **Independent Deployment & Scaling:** Develop and maintain specialized functions separately, allowing serverless execution without overloading your main application components.
- **Integration Bridge:** Seamlessly integrate custom external libraries, complex calculations, and heavy data-processing tasks directly into your Zoho platform ecosystem

2414011100



Environments :

The Environment feature helps developers manage an application across different stages of development without affecting the live application.

Example

Suppose you create a Student Management System in Zoho Creator.

Development → Stage → Production

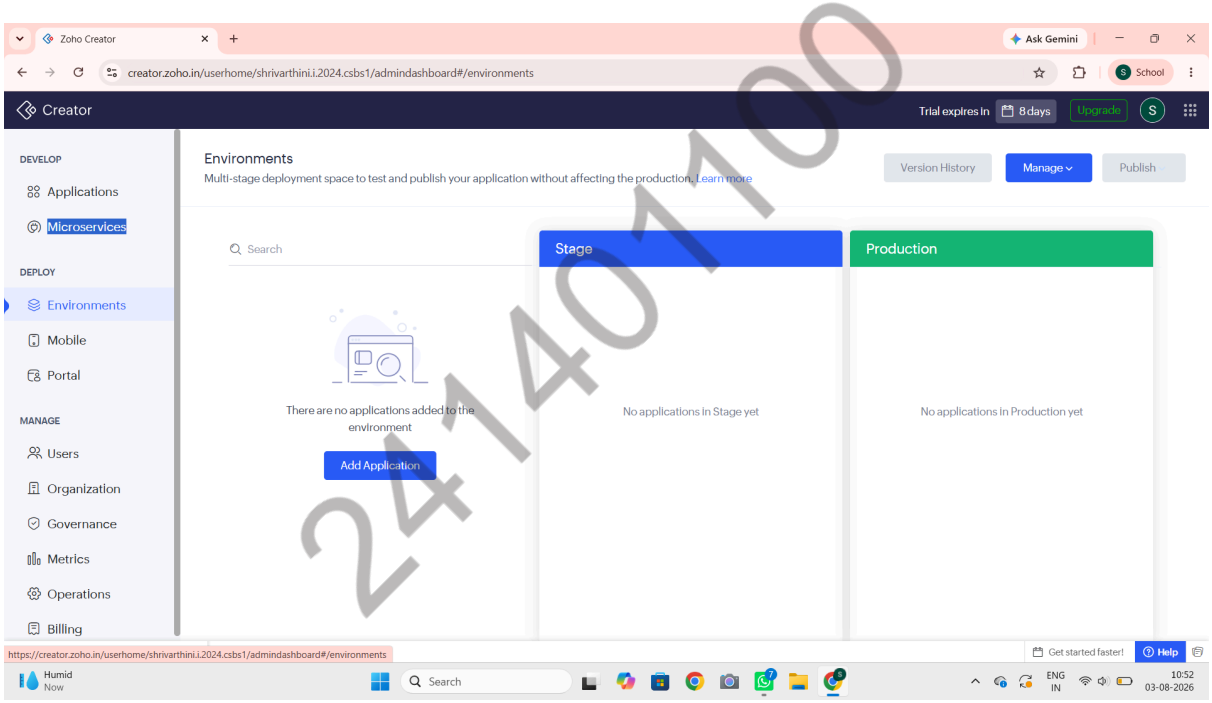
You first create a new Student Registration Form in Development.

Then you test it in Stage to make sure the form and workflows work correctly.

Finally, you deploy it to Production, where students and staff can use it.

Main advantage

The biggest benefit is safe development and deployment. Developers can work on new features and test them without disturbing the live application.



24140100

Mobile :

The Mobile feature in Zoho Creator, it allows users to access and use Zoho Creator applications from mobile devices such as smartphones and tablets.The mobile feature helps users work with their Creator applications anytime and anywhere using a mobile device.

Main features:

Access Applications

Users can open their Zoho Creator applications from a mobile phone or tablet.

Add and View Data

Users can fill out forms and add new records. They can also view existing data and reports.

Mobile-Friendly Interface

Applications can be used on smaller screens, making it convenient for mobile users.

Work on the Go

Employees can perform tasks while they are away from their computers. For example, a salesperson can update customer information while visiting a client.

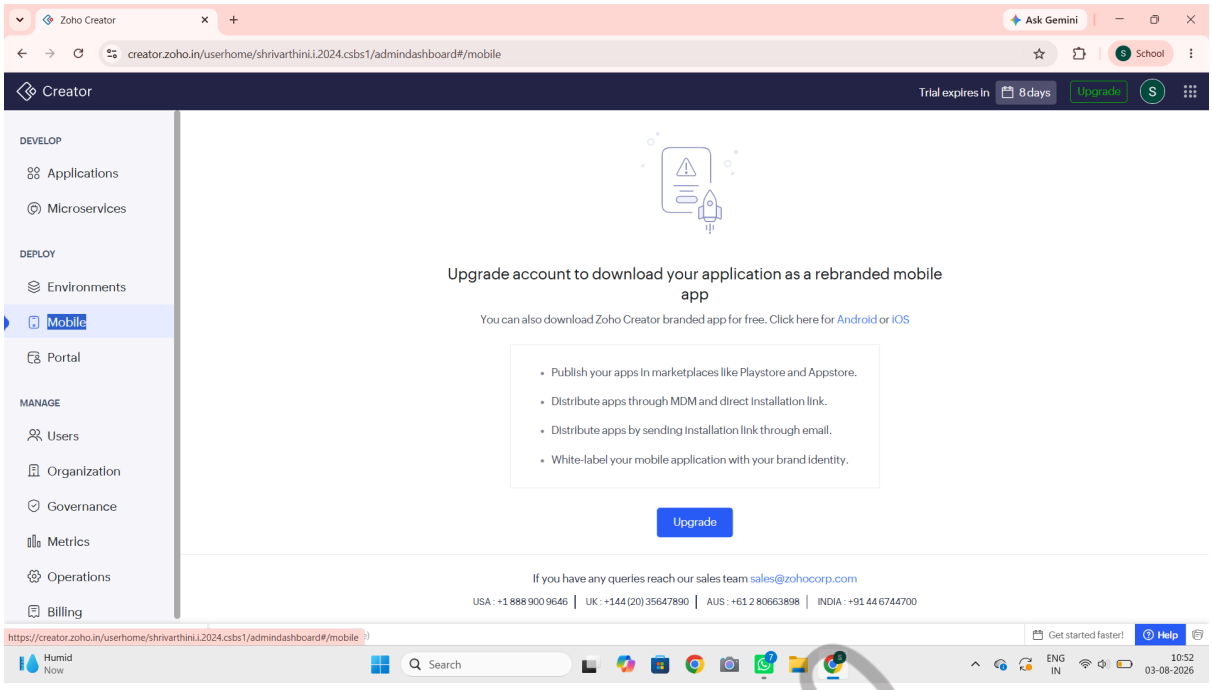
Access Reports and Dashboards

Users can check important information, reports, and dashboards from their mobile devices.

Use Device Features

Depending on the application and permissions, Creator apps can make use of mobile capabilities such as camera, location, and notifications.

241401100



24140100

Portal :

The Portal feature in Zoho Creator allows you to give external users such as customers, vendors, students, or business partners access to your application. Instead of giving them access to your entire Zoho Creator account, you can provide them with a separate portal where they can access only the information and features you choose.

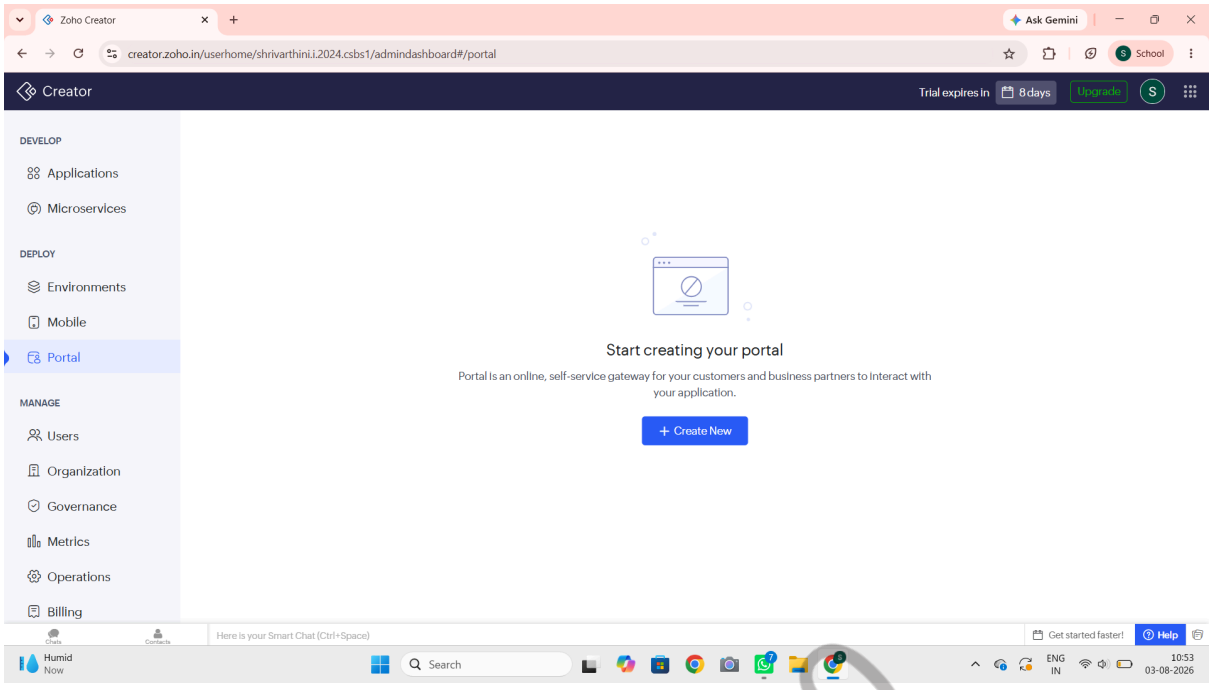
Example

College Admin → Zoho Creator Application → Student Portal → Students

The admin manages the complete application, while students use the portal to access only the features provided to them.

Main advantage

The main benefit of the Portal feature is secure external access. It allows you to connect your application with customers or other external users while controlling what they can see and do.



2414011100

User :

The User feature in Zoho Creator is used to manage the people who can access and use your application. You can control who has access and what they are allowed to do.

Main functions

1. Add Users

You can add people who need to use your application.

2. Manage User Access

You can decide which users can access your application.

3. Assign Roles

Different users can have different roles, such as Admin, Manager, or Employee.

4. Set Permissions

You can control what each user is allowed to do.

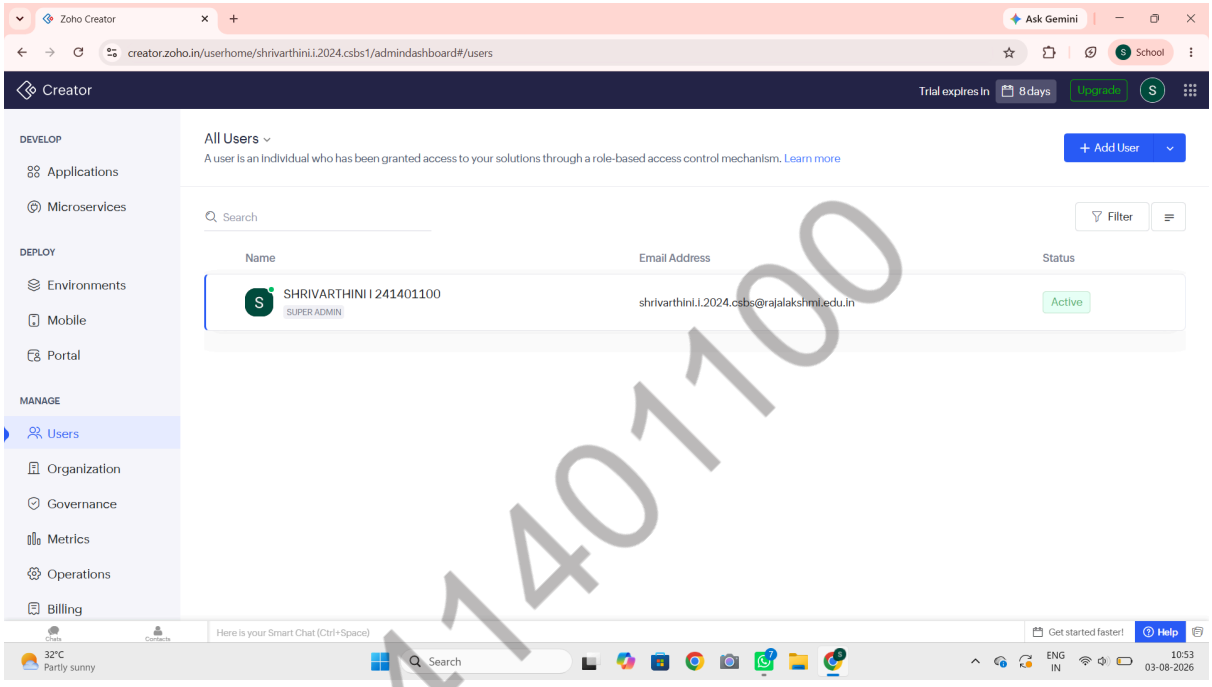
For example, one user may only view data, while another can add, edit, or delete data.

5. Control Application Access

Users can be given access to specific applications or components based on their role and permissions.

User: Usually refers to people who are part of the organization's application users and are given access based on roles and permissions.

Portal User: Usually refers to external users, such as customers, students, or vendors, who access selected parts of the application through a portal.



241401100

Organisation :

The Organisation feature in Zoho Creator is used to manage the organisation or company details associated with your Zoho Creator account and applications.

It helps you manage your organisation's setup, users, and account-related settings from a central place.

Main functions

1. Organisation Details

Manage basic information about your organisation.

2. User Management

Add or manage users who belong to your organisation.

Control user access based on their roles and permissions.

3. Roles and Permissions

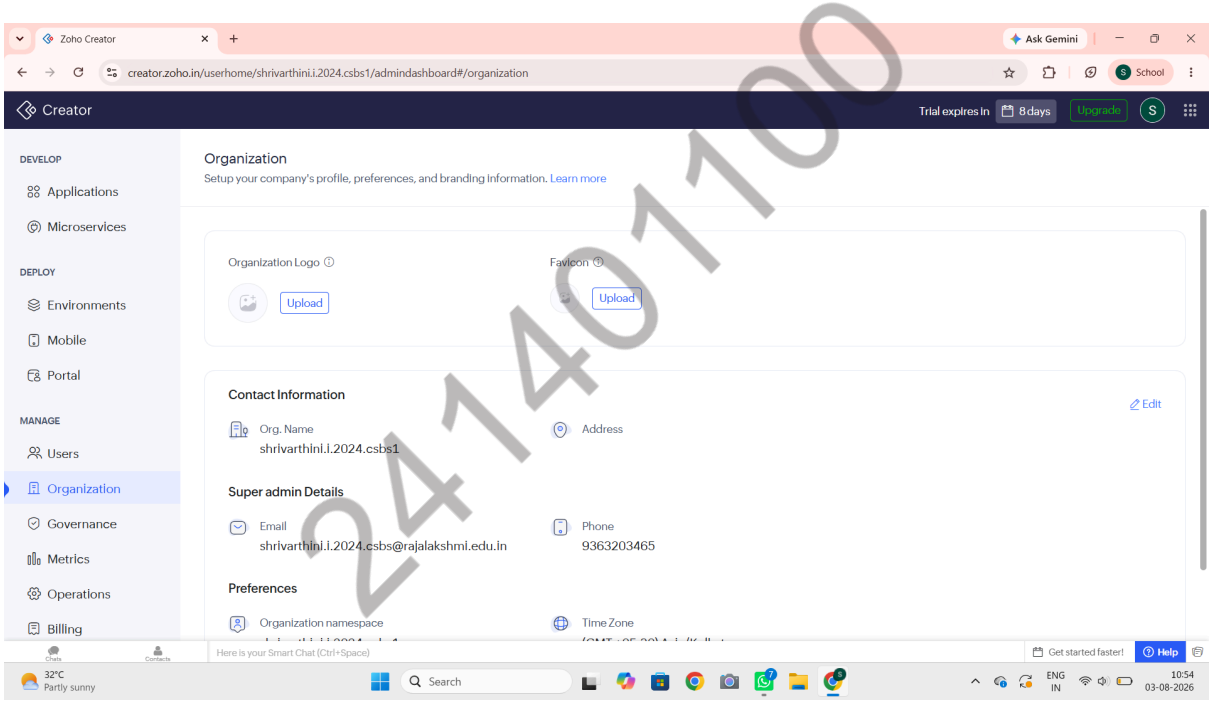
Define what different users can access or manage.

4. Organisation-Level Settings

Manage settings that apply to your organisation and its Creator environment.

5. Centralised Management

Administrators can manage applications, users, and organisation-related settings in one place.



Governance:

The Governance feature in Zoho Creator helps an organisation control, monitor, and manage how applications are developed and used. It is especially useful when many developers and teams are creating applications. It ensures that applications follow the organisation's rules, security policies, and best practices.

Main functions

1. Control Application Development

Helps organisations maintain standards when creating and managing applications.

2. Manage Users and Access

Ensures that only authorised people can access applications and perform specific actions.

3. Security and Compliance

Helps protect organisational data and maintain security requirements.

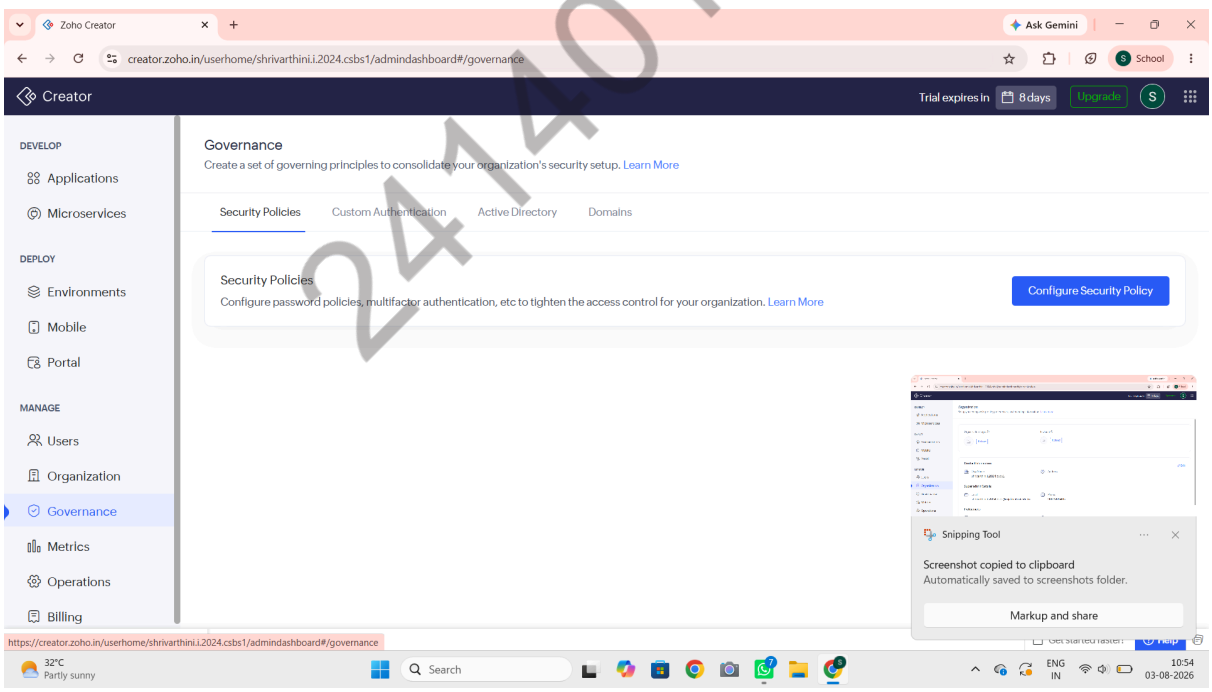
4. Monitor Applications

Administrators can keep track of applications and their usage.

5. Standardisation

Helps different teams follow common rules and guidelines while building applications.

2414011100



Metrics :

The Metrics feature in Zoho Creator helps you monitor and analyse the performance and usage of your applications. It gives administrators useful

information about how applications are being used and how well they are performing.

Main functions

1. Monitor Application Usage

Helps you understand how frequently your applications are being used.

2. Track Performance

Helps identify performance-related issues and areas that may need improvement.

3. Analyse User Activity

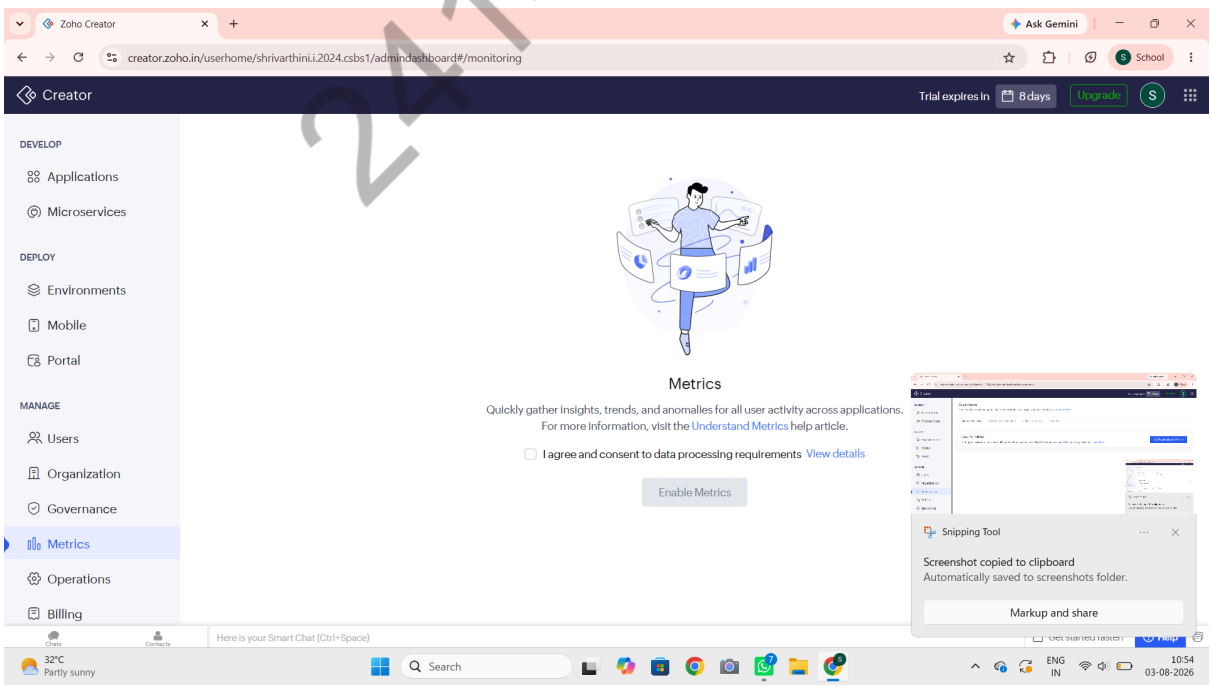
Provides insights into user activity and application usage.

4. Identify Problems

Helps administrators detect unusual activity or performance issues.

5. Make Better Decisions

The collected metrics can help organisations improve their applications and manage resources effectively.



2414011100

Operations :

The Operations feature in Zoho Creator helps administrators and developers monitor and manage the operational activities of their applications. It provides tools to keep applications running smoothly and helps identify issues that may affect users.

Main functions

1. Monitor Applications

Helps you keep track of your applications and their operational status.

2. Monitor Performance

Helps identify performance problems that could make an application slow or affect its operation.

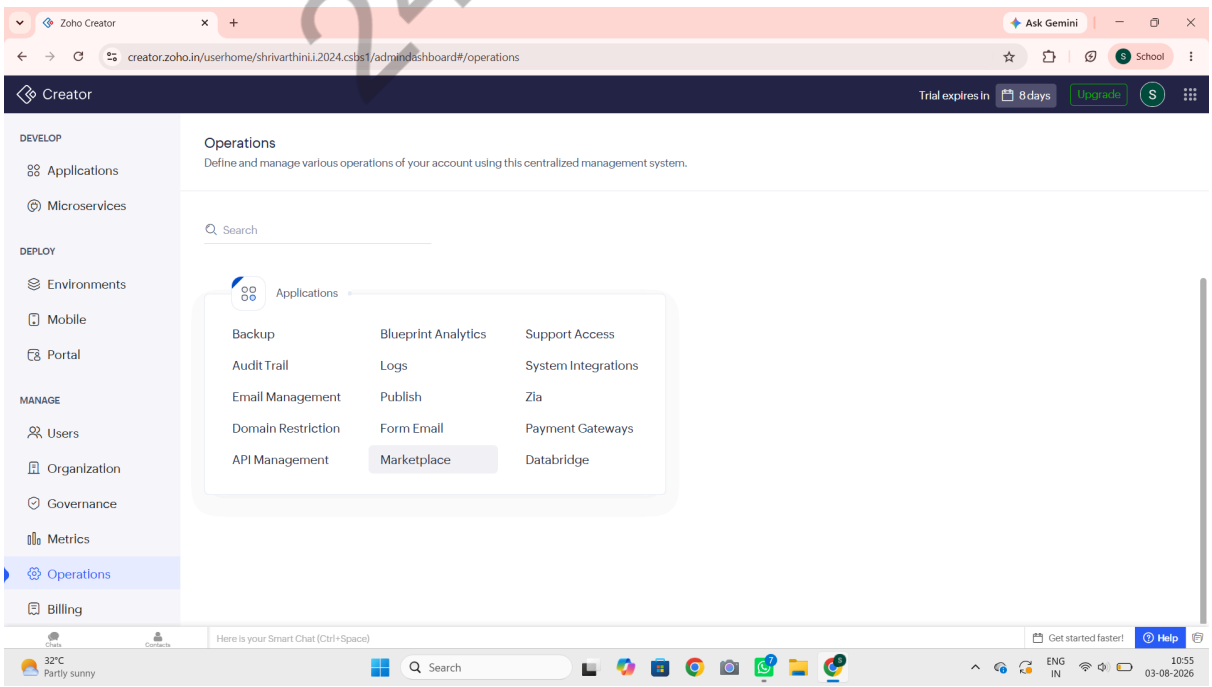
3. Track Errors

Helps detect errors and issues occurring in applications so they can be investigated and fixed.

4. Manage Application Operations: Provides administrators with information needed to maintain applications effectively.

5. Troubleshooting : Helps developers and administrators find problems and take corrective actions.

2414011100



Billing:

The Billing feature in Zoho Creator is used to manage and monitor the subscription and payment details of your Zoho Creator account or organisation.

It helps administrators keep track of their plan, billing cycle, and payment-related information.

Main functions

1. Manage Subscription

View and manage the Zoho Creator subscription plan used by your organisation.

2. Billing Information

Manage billing-related details associated with the account.

3. View Invoices

Access invoices and payment records for the subscription.

4. Payment Management

Manage payment methods and subscription payments.

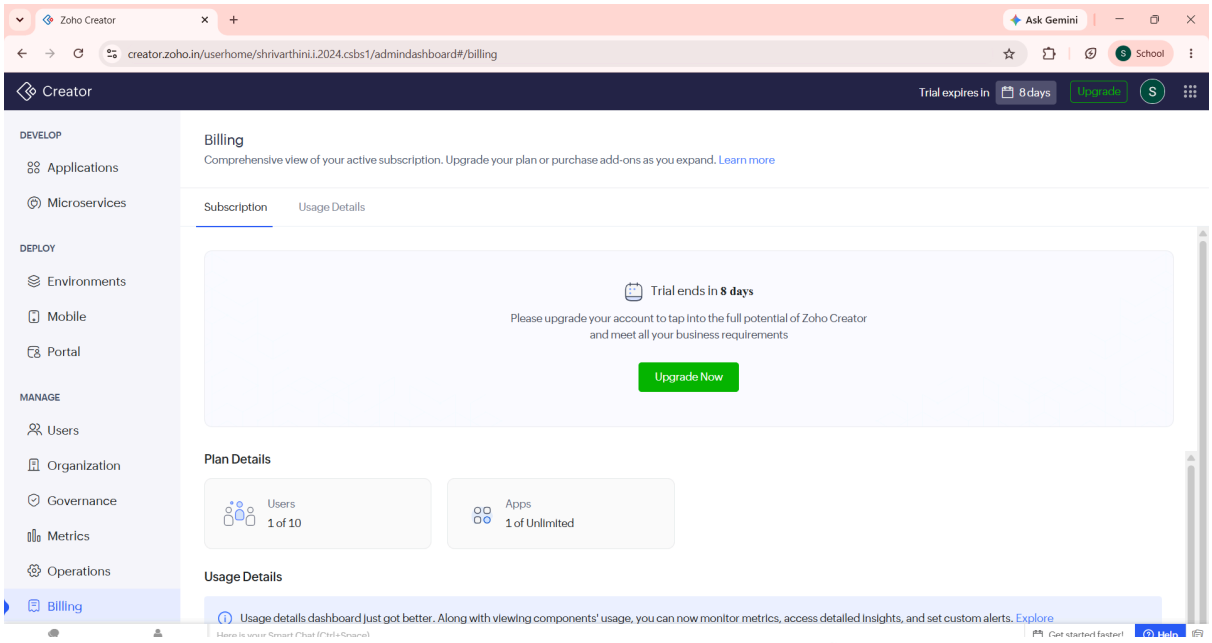
5. Plan and Usage

Check information related to the current plan and usage, where applicable.

6. Upgrade or Downgrade

Change the subscription plan based on the organisation's requirements.

24140100



Architecture Diagram of Zoho Creator :

